

Canadian Rockies & the Okanagan

Ten days from Calgary: Highwood Pass, Banff and Lake Louise, the Icefields Parkway to Jasper, west past Mount Robson to the Okanagan wine country, and home over Rogers Pass and through Kootenay National Park, with golf at Banff Springs and Jasper Park Lodge.

10 days: 8 riding, 2 golf · **Riding:** about 2,000 km (1,250 mi) · **Start and finish:** Calgary · **Best:** July to September
· **Park pass:** Parks Canada Discovery Pass

Arrive Calgary

Fly into Calgary and collect the bikes.

Overnight: Calgary

Day 1 Calgary to Banff

About 230 km (145 mi)

South-west into Kananaskis Country and over Highwood Pass on Highway 40, at 2,206 m the highest paved pass in Canada (open June 15 to November 30). North through Kananaskis to Canmore and into Banff.

By way of: Longview · Highway 40 · Highwood Pass · Kananaskis Village · Canmore

Overnight: Banff

Day 2 Golf at Banff Springs

A round at the Fairmont Banff Springs course between the Bow River and Mount Rundle. Ride the Lake Minnewanka loop in the evening.

Overnight: Banff

Day 3 Banff to Jasper

About 290 km (180 mi)

The Bow Valley Parkway to Lake Louise and up to Moraine Lake, then the Icefields Parkway: 232 km of glaciers, turquoise lakes and mountain walls. Stops at Bow Lake, Peyto Lake, the Columbia Icefield and Athabasca Falls.

By way of: Bow Valley Parkway · Lake Louise · Moraine Lake · Icefields Parkway · Peyto Lake · Columbia Icefield · Athabasca Falls

Overnight: Jasper

Day 4 Golf at Jasper Park Lodge

A round at Fairmont Jasper Park Lodge, then Maligne Canyon and the Maligne Lake road in the evening, the best time to see wildlife.

Overnight: Jasper

Day 5 Jasper to Clearwater

About 320 km (200 mi)

West over the Yellowhead Pass into British Columbia, past Mount Robson, the highest peak in the Canadian Rockies, then south down the North Thompson valley. Wells Gray Park's waterfalls are just north of Clearwater.

By way of: Yellowhead Pass · Mount Robson · Valemount · Blue River

Overnight: Clearwater

Day 6 Clearwater to Kelowna

About 250 km (155 mi)

Down the Thompson to Kamloops, then south through Vernon and along Kalamalka and Okanagan lakes into Kelowna, the heart of BC wine country.

By way of: Kamloops · Vernon · Kalamalka Lake · Lake Country

Overnight: Kelowna

Day 7 Okanagan wine loop

About 150 km (95 mi)

A short, easy day: down the east side of Okanagan Lake to the Naramata Bench wineries above Penticton, and back along the west side through Summerland and Peachland. Leave the tasting until the bike is parked.

By way of: Naramata Bench · Penticton · Summerland · Peachland

Overnight: Kelowna

Day 8 Kelowna to Revelstoke

About 200 km (125 mi)

North past Vernon and Shuswap Lake to Sicamous, then east along the Eagle River to Revelstoke. In the afternoon, ride the Meadows in the Sky Parkway up Mount Revelstoke.

By way of: Vernon · Enderby · Sicamous · Eagle Pass · Meadows in the Sky Parkway

Overnight: Revelstoke

Day 9 Revelstoke to Radium Hot Springs

About 255 km (160 mi)

East over Rogers Pass through Glacier National Park to Golden, then south down the Columbia Valley between the Rockies and the Purcells to Radium Hot Springs. End the day in the hot pools.

By way of: Rogers Pass · Glacier National Park · Golden · Columbia Valley

Overnight: Radium Hot Springs

Day 10 Radium Hot Springs to Calgary

About 270 km (170 mi)

Up through Sinclair Canyon into Kootenay National Park on Highway 93: the Paint Pots, Marble Canyon and over Vermilion Pass on the Continental Divide, then down to Banff and back to Calgary.

By way of: Sinclair Canyon · Kootenay National Park · Paint Pots · Marble Canyon · Vermilion Pass · Banff

Overnight: Calgary

Depart Fly home from Calgary

Return the bikes and fly home.

Riding notes

- Wildlife on the road is the main hazard: elk, deer, bighorn sheep and bears, especially at dawn and dusk.
 - Fuel is limited on the Icefields Parkway; the only station is at Saskatchewan Crossing. Fill up in Lake Louise.
 - Expect cool mornings at altitude even in summer, and wildfire smoke some years.
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Golf

- Fairmont Banff Springs
 - Fairmont Jasper Park Lodge
 - Predator Ridge near Vernon, if you want a round in the Okanagan on Day 7
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Park pass

- A Parks Canada Discovery Pass covers Banff, Jasper, Yoho, Kootenay, Glacier and Mount Revelstoke national parks.

Draft route. Distances and times are approximate; check road, pass and ferry conditions before each day.